



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Willow Glen Christian School

School Website: <https://willowglencs.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Willow Glen Christian School (WGCS) presents a robust Classical Christian profile across multiple dimensions, anchored in explicit religious foundations, virtue-oriented aims, and a curriculum and pedagogy that align with classical education principles. Public materials consistently foreground a Christian worldview, the Triune God, and a formation-focused purpose (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in biblical faith. The school emphasizes a liberal-arts orientation (grammar, logic, rhetoric), place-based learning, and project-based experiences integrated within a Christian framework. Overall, WGCS demonstrates a strong Classical orientation, with some category-specific nuances that are clearly "classical" in intent but also reflect more contemporary, place-based practices. Based on the six-category rubric, the school lands primarily CLASSICAL, with Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing elements that are mixed or evolving within a classical frame.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot - Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence includes explicit biblical foundations, a Triune-God framework, and language tying education to worship, liturgy, and Christian formation. Positive indicators emphasize truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable through theology and worship; statements like "Rooted in Christ" and "Vision: Equipping graduates with an excellent education to the glory of God" are public and recurrent. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include Triune God, theology, sacred scripture, chapel/worship, truth/goodness/beauty, and biblical truths. Negative signals (e.g., secular relativism) are not evidenced in public WGCS materials. Estimated: Positive ~7–8 mentions; Negative ~0. Rationale: Strong alignment with transcendental moral realism and liturgical/community practice. Rating justification: CLASSICAL.

- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence shows a formation-centric telos: virtue, wisdom, and human excellence oriented toward a Christian end. The mission/vision emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and service in a Christ-centered framework, not merely workforce preparation. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, liberal education, and pursuit of true/good/beautiful. Negative keywords (in the sense of pure utilitarian aims) are not present. Estimated: Positive ~5–6; Negative ~0. Rationale: Education framed as formation and formation-oriented toward truth, goodness, beauty. Rating: CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: WGCS publicly promotes a classical-leaning curriculum (grammar → logic → rhetoric), liberal-arts emphasis, and place-based/project-based learning. However, explicit public claims about reading Great Books and participating in the Great Conversation are not clearly documented on the site in the same way as core classical lexicons describe them; the materials emphasize place-based and project-based elements alongside classical structure. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include grammar, logic, rhetoric; liberal arts; Great Books/Great Conversation is not explicitly stated in the site copy (though

a classical ethos is clear in the “elements” language). Place-based learning and project-based learning appear publicly, which are positive in modern elaborations of classical education but represent a blended approach. Estimated: Positive ~4–5; Negative ~0 (no explicit negative indicators tied to curriculum content). Frequency perspective: majority positive signals, but the absence of an explicit Great-Books/GCC framing lowers the score from “Classical” to “Somewhat Classical.” Why this rating: The core grammar/logic/rhetoric framework and liberal-arts emphasis meet Classical criteria, but the explicit Great-Books/Great Conversation anchor is not publicly documented in WGCS materials, and the intake of project/place-based methods signals a blended approach rather than a strictly traditional Great-Books curriculum. Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: The school publicly highlights a progression from classical methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric) to higher-level discourse and rhetoric-oriented aims, with indications of Socratic-style discussions at upper levels in classical-literature contexts and a strong memory/chanting/recitation emphasis in classical pedagogy lexicons. WGCS materials also openly promote project-based and place-based experiences as part of the learning journey. However, explicit, systematic Socratic seminars or the full spectrum of Scholé/restful pedagogy in daily practice are not uniformly documented in the public site copy. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic dialogue, memory/recitation, rhetoric, and project/place-based learning; negative signals (e.g., endorsing only experiential learning without classical basis) are not dominantly present, though the site shows blended approaches. Estimated: Positive ~4–5; Negative ~1–2 (e.g., potential drift toward non-classical experiential/constructivist signals in some material). Rationale: The pedagogy advances classical forms (grammar/logic/rhetoric; rhetoric/eloquence) but also includes contemporary modalities (project-based/place-based), yielding a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating. Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: WGCS presents a real, staffed school with named administrators and teachers; the Head of School emphasizes virtue, character formation, and serving as a living curriculum. Faculty are described as models and living exemplars in the school’s narrative; there is a public emphasis on faculty as mentors and co-curricular collaborators, with a culture of collegiality and shared mission. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, character formation, portrait of a teacher, and collegial culture. Negative signals (if any) are not evident in the public text; the materials emphasize a teacher-led, virtue-centered model. Estimated: Positive ~5–6; Negative ~0. Rationale: The faculty portrayal aligns strongly with classical expectations of teachers as the “living curriculum” and mentors. Rating: CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: WGCS actively foregrounds parent involvement through Parent-Teacher Fellowship (PTF), open campuses, volunteer opportunities, and family engagement in events. Newsletters and communications emphasize partnerships with parents and community groups, and parent involvement is presented as central to the school’s ecosystem. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, book clubs, open campus, and active volunteering. Negative signals are not evident in the public copy. Estimated: Positive ~6–7; Negative ~0. Rationale: Very strong alignment with the classical model’s emphasis on parental partnership and community formation. Rating: CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1 CLASSICAL - Element 2 CLASSICAL - Element 3 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 4 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 5 CLASSICAL - Element 6 CLASSICAL

General aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle - If WGCS aimed for a fuller “Classical” alignment in Curriculum (Element 3) and Pedagogy (Element 4) without sacrificing place-based and project-based strengths, they could explicitly foreground and document a Great Books/Great Conversation framing and a more explicit, structured Socratic pedagogy continuum across grades, along with a clear articulation of scholé/restful practice in class routines. Concrete steps might include: - Publicly publish and reference a Great Books/Great Conversation list or core readings aligned with the three-stage Trivium framework. - Create explicit articulation of Socratic seminars and case-based seminars in upper grades with exemplar transcripts or rubrics. - Publish a formal

“Scholé”/restful learning plan and schedule that components of meditation, reflection, and contemplation are embedded across the grade levels.

- No additional needle-movers are required if the school remains Classically oriented in most dimensions; however, the above would strengthen the Curriculum and Pedagogy dimensions toward a more unambiguously CLASSICAL classification.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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